

♦ DECK · 46 CARDS

Two decks, **no Diamond suit**.

Keep A · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 · J · Q + Jokers:

6× each of A, 2, 3, 4, 5, J

4× Ordinary Queens · **2×** Heart Queens

2× Big Jokers · **2×** Small Jokers

♦ SETUP

Deal **18** cards to each player. Set the other **10 aside face down** as the set-aside pile, unused except as noted by certain contracts.

♦ BID & PLAY

Bid. The player with fewer points bids first (random on hand 1). Bid higher to stay in. A pass closes the auction. The last, highest bidder becomes declarer and must play the contract they bid.

Play. Declarer aims to shed out before the defender. On a turn, lead any legal play, beat the current combination, shovel, or pass. When one player passes, the other leads next. The hand ends when a player empties their hand, or earlier through contract failure or escape.

♦ CONTRACTS

CONTRACT	IF DECLARED	WIN / LOSS
 Quiet (1ST BIDDER)	No one declares. First to shed out wins.	9
 Breakaway (DECLARER) ★	No added conditions.	15/ 10
 Forced Shovel (DECLARER)	Declarer must not play Aces except to shovel or in their final play. Whenever a legal shovel is available, declarer must shovel.	21/ 14
 Buried Treasure (DECLARER) ★	Reveal the top 3 set-aside. Defender keeps 1 or 2, declarer takes the rest.	27/ 18
 Red Finish (DEFENDER) ★	Declarer's final play must contain a Heart Queen.	42/ 28
 The Chase (DEFENDER)	Declarer takes the top 3 set-aside, then must shed out before the defender is down to 2 cards after a turn.	54/ 36
 Shutout (DECLARER)	Declarer sheds out before the defender plays a single card, even a shovel.	84/ 56

Win = declarer succeeds. **Loss** = defender scores. Scorer also gets **+1 per card** left in the loser's hand (capped at the contract score earned, no bonus for Shutout). Play to **150 or 250** points, or to any previously agreed number of hands or points.

♦ CARD RANK

high → low



Heart Queens stand apart: they pair only with each other, never with ordinary Queens. **Jokers** play as singles or same-kind pairs only (never in runs).

♦ LEGAL PLAYS

TYPE	MADE OF
Single	One card.
Pair	Two of a rank. Heart Queens & same-kind Jokers may pair.
Set	Three to six of a rank. Heart Queens & Jokers cannot form sets.
Single Run	4 or 5 consecutive singles using A · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 only.
Connected Sets	3+ consecutive equal-size groups using A · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 only.

Match the **type and shape**, then play a higher rank. Runs and connected sets compare by their highest card or group. **No bombs, no cross-type beating.**

♦ SHOVEL · ACES

PLAY	CAPTURE
A →	a pair
A · A →	a triple
A · A · A →	a 4-of-a-kind
A · A · A · A →	a 5-of-a-kind
A · A · A · A · A →	a 6-of-a-kind

Play Aces to **capture** pairs and sets. The Aces become the **current play**. **Heart Queens** and **Jokers** cannot be shovelled.